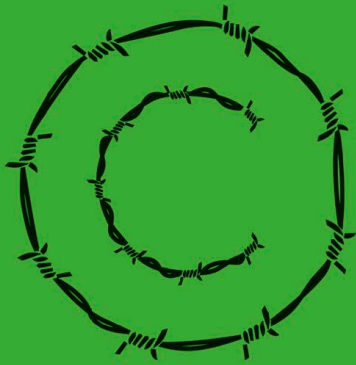




IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Copyright law

BEFORE

1886 Signatory nations to the Berne Convention agree to respect international copyright.

1909 In the US, the Copyright Act overhauls the copyright protection given to authors.

1988 The Copyright, Designs, and Patent Act becomes law in the UK.

AFTER

2016 Google alone receives more than 900 million takedown requests in a year.

2018 The Music Modernization Act in the US widens the scope of copyright and royalty rights protection for artists whose music is streamed.

2019 The EU Directive on Copyright puts the onus on internet service providers to stop copyright infringement.

IF CREATIVITY IS A FIELD, COPYRIGHT IS A FENCE

THE WIPO COPYRIGHT TREATY (1996)

The Berne Convention of 1886 was the first attempt to regulate copyright internationally. Initially, just 10 nations signed up to it, but now, administered by the UN's World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO), it has 178 signatories.

The very first copyright law had been the Statute of Anne, passed by the British Parliament in 1710,

but it did not apply outside Britain. The Berne Convention extended copyright protection to authors and artists in an ever-growing number of countries—recognizing both that they are the legal owners of the work they produce and that they should be the main beneficiaries of their labor. The Convention also stated that copyright did not need to be asserted but was vested

Internet service providers (ISPs) host art, music, films, photographs, articles, and books online.



Much of this **online content** infringes copyright, with the result that the **original creators** are **not paid royalties**.



The **WCT** extends the Berne Convention to cover **digital content**, and the **Music Modernization Act** deals with **streamed music**.



Despite legislation, enforcing the principle of **content ownership** across the internet **remains challenging**.